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Consent Form for IRB-FY2024-8635

New York University
Department of Psychology
6 Washington Place
New York, NY 10003

Principal Investigator: Sebastian Michelmann (s.michelmann@nyu.edu)

Introduction: You have been invited to participate in a study to learn more about human memory by recording brain activity with magnetoencephalography (MEG). This study is conducted by Dr. Sebastian Michelmann, of the Department of Psychology at New York University or a designated lab member working under the supervision of Dr. Michelmann.

Procedures: If you agree to be in this study, your brain activity will be measured from sensors arranged in a helmet while you perform memory task(s). Participation in this study will involve one MEG session, which will take up to 3 hours of your time, including up to 60 minutes of experiment set up. During preparation, 3-5 small marker coils will be attached to your head using minimal-contact medical tape, and a small spatial digitizing device will be used to record the 3D positions of the marker coils and landmarks on your head. Before you enter the magnetically shielded room with the MEG instrument, you will need to remove any metal and electromagnetic items. During the MEG scan, your left eye will be tracked using a camera placed above the MEG scanner bed. For eye-tracking calibration purposes, you will be asked to follow dots on a screen with your eyes before starting the study and roughly every 10 minutes during the study. Completing the task(s) will take up to 2 hours. If needed, breaks of a few minutes will be provided. You will remain positioned within the MEG helmet in place during breaks, but you may close your eyes and rest. You may rest for as long as you need to be ready to continue the session(s).

During this study, you will be asked to do one or more of the following:

- Lay in front of a computer monitor and view visual stimuli, listen to auditory stimuli (e.g., stories, words), or learn associations between stimuli (e.g., symbols, words, images, videos, audios, stories).
- Perform simple tasks (e.g., counting down in steps of 13, doing simple math, identifying atypical stimuli in a series of typical stimuli, or making judgments on odd/even numbers).
- Identify moments within a story/video, or recall the learned stimuli (e.g., freely reporting what you learned, identifying associates from a series of options, deciding whether a stimulus has been previously seen, judging the similarity of a stimulus to previously seen ones, or deciding whether a shown association is intact or has been rearranged).
- Allow videotaping of your eye during the session. These images will be used to compute when and where your eyes are moving during the tasks.
- Allow audio recordings to be collected if responses are verbal.

Risks: There are no known significant risks or side effects associated with MEG recordings. You might feel slight discomfort from the medical tape applied to your skin. You may notify the research staff at any time if you feel uncomfortable, for any reason. You will be in contact with the research staff throughout the experiment. Despite all the care and precautions taken by the investigators, there may be risks associated with this study that we do not know about. If you think that you have experienced a research-related injury, please contact Sebastian Michelmann at (609) 285-6734 or s.michelmann@nyu.edu.

Benefits: Although you will not receive direct benefits, this research may help the investigator understand the neurocognitive mechanisms of human memory better.

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Cost and Compensation: You will be paid $20/h for MEG sessions; should you withdraw before the end of the study, you will receive a partial payment for the duration of your participation, rounded to the nearest half-hour. There will be no cost to you associated with participation in this study.

Rights and Questions: Participation in this study is voluntary. You may refuse to participate or withdraw at any time without penalty. Nonparticipation or withdrawal will not affect your grades or academic standing. You also have the right to review video or audio tapes or photographs of your sessions and request that any or all portions be destroyed. If there is anything about the study or your participation that is unclear or that you do not understand, or if you have questions or wish to report a research-related problem, you may contact Sebastian Michelmann at (609) 285-6734, s.michelmann@nyu.edu, New York University, Department of Psychology, 6 Washington Pl, Room 859, New York, NY 10003. For questions about your rights as a research participant, you may contact the University Committee on Activities Involving Human Subjects (UCAIHS), 665 Broadway, Suite 804, New York University, (212) 998-4808 or ask.humansubjects@nyu.edu. Please reference the study number IRB-FY2024-8635 when contacting the UCAIHS.

Confidentiality: Confidentiality of your research records will be strictly maintained. Information will be stored in the investigator's file and will be identified by a code number. The code key connecting your name to specific information about you will be kept in a separate, secure location. Information not containing identifiers may be used in future research or shared with other researchers without your additional consent. The results of this study may be published in a book, journal, or used for teaching purposes. However, information that could identify you will never be shared unless you explicitly provide written authorization, which will be requested in writing. Information not containing identifiers may be shared for teaching purposes, research (such as in academic databases), or displayed at scientific conferences or in publications.

Agreement to Participate: YOUR SIGNATURE INDICATES THAT YOU HAVE READ THE ABOVE INFORMATION, THAT YOU HAVE DISCUSSED THIS STUDY WITH THE PERSON OBTAINING CONSENT, THAT YOU HAVE DECIDED TO PARTICIPATE BASED ON THE INFORMATION PROVIDED, THAT YOU ARE 18 YEARS OF AGE OR OLDER, AND THAT A COPY OF THIS CONSENT DOCUMENT HAS BEEN GIVEN TO YOU TO KEEP.

_____ _____

Participant's Signature Date

_____

Participant's Printed Name

I certify that I have presented the above information to the subject and secured his/her/their consent.

_____ _____

Experimenter's Signature Date

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